

# Linear and Nonlinear Kalman Filtering: theory and applications

SCUDO/DAUSY/DRIM Ph.D. course A.Y. 2026

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## 1 General info about the course and Introduction

# Schedule

| <b>Date</b>     | <b>Time</b>       | <b>Tentative Topic</b>           |
|-----------------|-------------------|----------------------------------|
| Mon. 27/04/2026 | h10.30-12:30 (2h) | Intro e Preliminaries            |
| Mon. 04/05/2026 | h09.30-12:30 (3h) | Preliminaries/Linear Theory      |
| Mon. 11/05/2026 | h09.30-12:30 (3h) | Linear Theory                    |
| Mon. 18/05/2026 | h09.30-13:30 (4h) | Linear Theory + Essay            |
| Mon. 25/05/2026 | h09.30-13:30 (4h) | Linear/Nonlinear Theory + Essay  |
| Mon. 01/06/2026 | h09.30-13:30 (4h) | Nonlinear Theory/Adds-on + Essay |

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| Fri. 08/05/2026            | h10.30-13:30 (3h)            |                                  |
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| Fri. 15/05/2026            |                              |                                  |
| <del>Mon. 25/05/2026</del> | h09.30-13:30 (4h)            | Linear/Nonlinear Theory + Essay  |
| Fri. 22/05/2026            | h09.30-13:30 (4h)            | Linear/Nonlinear Theory + Essay  |
| <del>Mon. 01/06/2026</del> | h09.30-13:30 (4h)            | Nonlinear Theory/Adds-on + Essay |
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Practical coding essay + report:

- on a selected application: pick a topic possibly related to your need/research.
- partially developed during class.
- programming language: python – either using jupyter notebooks (recommended) or script based. Make sure all necessary dependencies to run are available.

**For other programming language ask first!!**

- no use of predefined libraries with KF implementations.
- you can work in a group if preferred.
- **objective:** explore (possibly all) the topics covered during the course, from linear to non-linear KF. You might need to start from modeling assumptions, linearize if necessary, discuss noise statistics and then implement the filter. Try to explore limits and nuances as if it were a small research project.
- present results in a pdf report<sup>1</sup>

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<sup>1</sup>For well organized runnable Jupyter notebooks this is optional. If, upon agreement, another language is used this is mandatory.

# References and additional material

- IT Picci, G. (2007). Filtraggio statistico (Wiener, Levinson, Kalman) e applicazioni. Libreria Progetto.**
- EN Sanso F., Pileggi, C. and Biagi, L. (2024). A tutorial on Kalman filtering. The linear, extended and unscented filters. (pdf available as resource in the material folder)**
- EN Anderson, B. D., and Moore, J. B. (2005). Optimal filtering. Courier Corporation.**

G-drive:

[https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1BbuSTi04wym0q0AqeLUkiVum\\_14kRRzD](https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1BbuSTi04wym0q0AqeLUkiVum_14kRRzD)

github: for complete slides, code and additional resources

[https://github.com/MarcoTodescato/linear\\_and\\_nonlinear\\_kalman\\_filtering](https://github.com/MarcoTodescato/linear_and_nonlinear_kalman_filtering)

For Q/A and discussion we can set up a Discord channel

# Goal

How to formulate estimation problems encountered in many engineering fields and applications as instances of a general dynamical system state estimation problem and how to derive the mathematical solution of the latter problem (possibly depending on additional assumption on the functional family of the considered dynamical system).

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**Essentially, this will lead to the well-known (linear) Kalman filter and its (nonlinear) extensions.**

# A bit of history: the theories of statistical filtering

## Wiener-Kolmogorov (1940)

- $I = (-\infty, t]$ , infinite time support
- $\{\mathbf{x}(t)\}$ ,  $\{\mathbf{y}(t)\}$  are weakly jointly stationary

The impulse response of the optimal filter is time-invariant hence it can be analytically computed once and for all times, knowing the processes statistics.

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## Levinson (1950)

- no more infinite (lower unbounded) time support

The impulse response of the filter is time-varying but can be efficiently computed at time  $t$  using a recursive structure which exploits the computations until  $t - 1$ .

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## Kalman (1960)

- signals can be modeled as stochastic dynamical systems of finite size

Looks for recursive finite-memory schemes that resembles that same dynamical system structure of finite size.

# A bit of history: a change of perspective

Revolutionary approach introduced by R.E. Kalman in 1960 to the problem of statistical filtering.

Change of perspective:

- **Wiener-Kolmogorov**: explicit computation of the filter **transfer function**, practically useful only for signals characterized by a **rational** spectral density
  - implicit computations possible only for rational signals
  - actual physical implementation of the filter as a set of difference (recursive) equations only for rational representations

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  - implicit computations possible only for rational signals
  - actual physical implementation of the filter as a set of difference (recursive) equations only for rational representations
- **Kalman**: hypothesis that the signals can be described as (linear) **dynamical systems** of finite dimension
  - no transfer functions involved
  - natural formulation of the filter as a fixed algorithmic structure essentially consisting of a discrete-time (linear) dynamical system of finite memory, driven by measurements
  - implementation always possible as a recursive algorithm

# Prediction vs Filtering vs Smoothing

Assume  $\{\mathbf{x}(t)\}$  and  $\{\mathbf{y}(t)\}$  are (second order<sup>2</sup>) processes of known dimensions. Denote with  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|I)$  the estimator of  $\mathbf{x}(t)$  given  $\{\mathbf{y}(t)\}_{t \in I}$ ,  $I$  being the time support. It is possible to identify 3 classes of estimation problems.

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<sup>2</sup>First and second moment statistics exist and are finite.

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## Prediction

Find  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t + h|I)$  being  $I = [t_0, t]$  and  $h > 0$ , that is the estimator  $h$ -step ahead in the future from measurements up to time  $t$ .

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## Filtering

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## Smoothing

Find  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|I)$  being  $I = [t_0, t_1]$  with  $t < t_1$ , that is the estimator at time  $t$  from all available measurements up to  $t_1$  in the future.

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- 2 Preliminaries: before diving in... some definitions and preliminary results

## Random signal

A random signal can be defined as the tuple  $(T, V, S)$  where

- $T$  is the set of time. We consider discrete-time signals,  $T = \mathbb{Z}$
- $V$  is the “alphabet” of signal values,  $V = \mathbb{R}$  or  $V = \mathbb{R}^n$
- $S$  is the sample space. Every  $s \in S$  is a function  $s : t \mapsto s(t)$  where  $t \in T$  and  $s(t) \in V$  also called *trajectory* of the signal.  $S$  specifies the a-priori admissible trajectories for the signal.

# Random signals and stochastic processes

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## Stochastic process

Mathematical formulation/description used to formally model the aleatoric nature of a random signal. Consisting of the tuple  $(S, \mathcal{S}, P)$  where:

- $S$  sample space. Set of all possible trajectories
- $\mathcal{S}$  set of all logical meaningful propositions or events regarding the signal
- $P$  probability measure on  $\mathcal{S}$ , i.e.  $P : \mathcal{S} \mapsto [0, 1]$  mapping every  $A \in \mathcal{S}$  to  $P(A) \in [0, 1]$ , the a-priori “confidence”  $A$  actually happening

# Stochastic process: weather example

Suppose we observe weather over 2 consecutive days where weather can be:

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- $S$  could be  $\{E_1, E_2\}$  where
  - $E_1$ : *it rains at least one day*  $:= \{(\sigma, \rho), (\rho, \sigma), (\rho, \rho)\}$
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  - $E_2$ : *the first sunny day*  $:= \{(\sigma, \sigma), (\sigma, \rho)\}$
- $P$ : assume weather is independent across days with  $P[\sigma] = 0.7$  and  $P[\rho] = 0.3$ . Then
  - $P[E_1] = (0.7 * 0.3) + (0.3 * 0.7) + (0.3 * 0.3) = 0.51$
  - $P[E_2] = 0.7^2 + (0.7 * 0.3) = 0.7$

# Stochastic process: robot navigation example

Assume there is a small robot moving on a 1D line. At each time it can either

- move to the right: +1
- stay still: 0

We observe trajectories of 2-steps  $(x_0, x_1, x_2)$  starting from  $x_0 = 0$ .

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- $P$ : assume independent movements  $P[0] = 0.7$  and  $P[+1] = 0.3$ . Then
  - $P[E_1] = (0.3 * 0.7) + (0.3 * 0.3) = 0.3$
  - $P[E_2] = 0.7^2 = 0.49$

**Obviously this can easily be made more complicated to describe more meaningful events.**

# A more general formulation

## Stochastic process (usual def in prob. theory)

A collection of random variables,  $\{y(t)\}$ , indexed by a temporal index  $t \in T$ , all defined on the same (abstract) probability space  $(\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P)$  where:

- $\Omega$  event set of “state of nature”  $\omega$
- $\mathcal{A}$   $\sigma$ -algebra of subsets of  $\Omega$
- $P$  probability measure on  $\mathcal{A}$

Each variable is a ( $\mathcal{A}$ -measurable) function  $y(t) : t \mapsto y(t, \omega)$ . The *trajectories* are the successive determinations  $\{y(\cdot, \tilde{\omega})\}$  of  $y(t)$  corresponding to a particular event  $\tilde{\omega} \in \Omega$

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Our definition  $(S, \mathcal{S}, P)$  is a “concrete path-based” version of the abstract  $(\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P)$ . If we define a variable  $y(t) \in (S, \mathcal{S}, P)$  as

$$y(t, s) := s(t)$$

where  $y(t)$  associates at every trajectory  $s \in S$  its value at  $t$ , then it is clear that, for varying  $t$ , the successive determinations of the variables  $\{y(t)\}$  corresponding to the event  $\bar{s} \in \mathcal{S}$  describe indeed the trajectory  $\{\bar{s}(t)\}$  of the process.

# Let's clarify...

The probabilistic formulation and formalization introduced is *just* a convenient choice to describe (or model) the unpredictable nature of a signal.

It is worth remembering that this is one possible choice that eventually allows one to resort to tools from probability theory to describe, handle and develop useful tools for filtering and identification.

For this reason, it is important to understand that, regardless the real nature of the underline signal, the same formulation (as *stochastic process*) can indeed be used to describe every signal (aleatoric or not).

On the other hand, it might be worth remembering that this choice is dictated by the “simplicity”, compactness and generality to describe events that could indeed also be described using a “deterministic” formulation.

# The Problem of *Estimation*: Estimate vs Measure

Statistical problem of estimation seen as formalization of the mathematical problem of measuring where the goal is that of getting information about a desired quantity  $x$ , non directly observable, based on observable data,  $y$ , whose values are produced by the measurement “instrument”.

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Ideally, knowing the “physical coupling”, i.e., relation, between  $x$  and  $y$  should allow to retrieve the value of  $x$  based on observable values of  $y$ . Practically, this relation is either not perfectly known or influenced by *environmental conditions* which introduce *uncertainty* in the measurement process.

$$y = h(x) \iff y = h(x) + \epsilon$$

As a consequence, the objective can be understood (or interpreted) as that of *estimating* the value of  $x$  based on the observed values of  $y$ .

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Following this “uncertainty-based” interpretation:

- it is not always straightforward how to generally get  $x$  from  $y$
- being impractical (meaningless) to reconstruct  $x$  with certainty, how to *best* approximate it?

# The Bayesian approach

$x$  assumed to be a random quantity characterized by some a-priori information

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## Notation: random variables vs sample values

It is important to understand the difference between a random variable, for which bold letters  $\mathbf{x}$  will be used vs the corresponding sample values, i.e., the actual value taken by the random variable, for which normal case letters  $x$  will be used.

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## Bayesian inference

Assume there exist a random variable/vector  $\mathbf{x}$  described by the probability density  $p_{\mathbf{x}}(\mathbf{x})$  and the random variable/vector  $\mathbf{y}$  of measurements described by the conditional density  $f(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x}) = f(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{x}) = \frac{P(\mathbf{y} \leq \mathbf{y} \leq \mathbf{y} + d\mathbf{y} | \mathbf{x} = \mathbf{x})}{d\mathbf{y}}$ .

The problem of Bayesian inference/estimation is that of reconstructing  $\mathbf{x}$  based on  $p_{\mathbf{x}}$ ,  $f(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x})$  and the observation of  $\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{y}$ . This can be understood as to:

- compute the new distribution of  $\mathbf{x}$  determined by the observation  $\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{y}$ , or
- reconstruct  $x = \mathbf{x}(\omega)$  determined by the “measurement” process

# Bayesian inference: complete reconstruction

Assuming  $p_{\mathbf{x}}(x)$  and  $f(y|x)$  completely known, the problem is that of computing

$$f(x|y) = \frac{f(y|x)p_{\mathbf{x}}(x)}{\int f(y|x)p_{\mathbf{x}}(x)dx} = \frac{p_{y\mathbf{x}}(y, x)}{p_y(y)}$$

i.e., the conditional *a-posteriori* density of  $\mathbf{x}$  given  $\mathbf{y} = y$ , which is the most exhaustive and complete description possible.

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Explicit analytical computation of the above equations often not possible.

In practice, this is rarely the case and/or even necessary because rather than an exhaustive description, a more handy point estimate of  $\mathbf{x}$ , telling us what is the unobservable sample value  $\mathbf{x} = x$  that gave rise to the observation  $\mathbf{y} = y$ , is more useful.

# Bayesian inference: point estimate

Assume the relation between  $\mathbf{x}$  and  $\mathbf{y}$  could analytically be described as

$$\mathbf{y} = h(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{w})$$

being  $\mathbf{w}$  the random vector capturing the variable interactions with the environment, i.e., the “measurement noise”.

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During the measurement process the particular experimental conditions  $\omega$  give raise to a specific determination  $\mathbf{w}(\omega) = \mathbf{w}$  which, in turn, give raise to an observed value  $\mathbf{y} = y$  linked to  $\mathbf{x} = x$  by the relation

$$y = h(x, w)$$

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Then, the problem is that of reconstructing the value  $\mathbf{x}$  of  $\mathbf{x}$  that “caused”  $\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{y}$  during the measurement process. Since estimating/knowing  $\mathbf{w}$  is intrinsically impossible, the problem is understood as that of “best” approximating  $\mathbf{x}$ .

# Bayesian inference: point estimate

Assume the relation between  $\mathbf{x}$  and  $\mathbf{y}$  could analytically be described as

$$\mathbf{y} = h(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{w})$$

being  $\mathbf{w}$  the random vector capturing the variable interactions with the environment, i.e., the “measurement noise”.

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It is then necessary to define a “reasonable” class of approximation criteria.

## Cost/Loss Function

It is called “loss/cost” a scalar function  $c : \mathbb{R}^n \mapsto \mathbb{R}$  of  $\xi = z - x$ ,  $z \in \mathbb{R}^n$ , s.t.  $c \geq 0$ ,  $c'' > 0$  (strictly convex) and  $c(0) = 0$ . It is said symmetric if  $c(-\xi) = c(\xi)$ .

E.g.:  $c(z - x) = \|z - x\|_Q^2$  where  $Q > 0$  symmetric and  $\|x\|_Q^2 = x^T Q x$ .

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# Bayesian inference: conditional/posterior expected risk

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## Conditional Expected Risk and Point Bayesian Estimate

Consider the *Conditional Expected Risk*

$$R(z, y) := \mathbb{E}[c(z - \mathbf{x}) | \mathbf{y} = y] = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} c(z - x) f(x|y) dx$$

Then, the *Point Bayesian Estimate* is defined as

$$\hat{x} = \text{Arg min}_z R(z, y)$$

## Theorem: Conditional Expectation

If the loss  $c$  is symmetric and the conditional density  $f(\cdot|y)$  is symmetric around its mean  $\mu(y) = \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y} = y] = \int \mathbf{x}f(\mathbf{x}|y)d\mathbf{x}$ , then  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}$  does not depend on  $c$  and it is equal to the conditional mean of  $\mathbf{x}$  given  $\mathbf{y} = y$ , i.e.,  $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y} = y]$ .

Moreover, if the cost  $c$  is of quadratic form, i.e.,  $\|\cdot\|_Q^2$ , then  $\hat{\mathbf{x}} = \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y} = y]$  for all types of conditional density  $f(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y})$  (assuming the conditional mean exists).

More generally, among all possible measurable functions  $g : \mathbb{R}^m \mapsto \mathbb{R}^n$ , for every symmetric  $Q > 0 \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ ,

$$\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y}] = \text{Arg min}_{g(\cdot)} \mathbb{E}[\|\mathbf{x} - g(\mathbf{y})\|_Q^2]$$

<sup>3</sup>Estimator: function (algorithm) of the observed data mapping them to point estimates.

# Bayesian inference: Conditional Expectation

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If the loss  $c$  is symmetric and the conditional density  $f(\cdot|y)$  is symmetric around its mean  $\mu(y) = \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y} = y] = \int x f(x|y) dx$ , then  $\hat{x}$  does not depend on  $c$  and it is equal to the conditional mean of  $\mathbf{x}$  given  $\mathbf{y} = y$ , i.e.,  $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y} = y]$ .

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Interpreted as a function of  $y$ , for symmetric  $c$  and  $f$ , the conditional mean  $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y}] : y \mapsto \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y} = y]$  is the Bayesian estimator<sup>3</sup>  $\hat{x}$  of  $x$  that minimizes the conditional expected risk  $R(z, y)$ . This is also true for any  $f$  if  $c$  is quadratic. In this case it is referred to as the *minimum squared Bayesian estimator*.

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# Theorem: Conditional Expectation (proof of last part)

For the law of total expectation, we can write

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[\|\mathbf{x} - g(\mathbf{y})\|_Q^2] &= \int_{\mathbb{R}} p_{\mathbf{y}}(y) \mathbb{E}[\|\mathbf{x} - g(\mathbf{y})\|_Q^2 | \mathbf{y} = y] dy \\&= \mathbb{E} [\mathbb{E}[\|\mathbf{x} - g(\mathbf{y})\|_Q^2 | \mathbf{y}]] \\&= \mathbb{E} [\mathbb{E}[\|\mathbf{x} - \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x} | \mathbf{y}] + \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x} | \mathbf{y}] - g(\mathbf{y})\|_Q^2 | \mathbf{y}]] \\&= \mathbb{E} \left[ \mathbb{E}[(\mathbf{x} - \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x} | \mathbf{y}])^T Q (\mathbf{x} - \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x} | \mathbf{y}]) | \mathbf{y}] \right. \\&\quad \left. + 2\mathbb{E}[(\mathbf{x} - \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x} | \mathbf{y}])^T Q [\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x} | \mathbf{y}] - g(\mathbf{y})] | \mathbf{y}] \right. \\&\quad \left. + \mathbb{E}[(\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x} | \mathbf{y}] - g(\mathbf{y}))^T Q [\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x} | \mathbf{y}] - g(\mathbf{y})] | \mathbf{y}] \right] \\&= \mathbb{E}[\|\mathbf{x} - \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x} | \mathbf{y}]\|_Q^2] + \mathbb{E}[\|\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x} | \mathbf{y}] - g(\mathbf{y})\|_Q^2]\end{aligned}$$

where the last equality holds by taking the mean and since the second double product term is zero conditioning on  $\mathbf{y}$ . And since the two terms are non-negative and the first does not depend on  $g$ , we can minimize the second by setting  $g(\mathbf{y}) = \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x} | \mathbf{y}]$ .

# Bayesian inference: MAP estimate

*What if, instead of minimizing risk, one wants to maximize gain?*

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## Expected gain

$$G(z, y) := \mathbb{E}[(z - \mathbf{x}) | \mathbf{y} = y] = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} \gamma(z - x) f(x|y) dx$$

being  $\gamma$  a concave function with its max in the origin.

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By choosing  $\gamma$  to arbitrarily approximate Dirac's impulse  $\delta \rightarrow G(z, y) \approx f(z|y)$

The corresponding Max Expected Gain (or *Maximum a Posterior* - M.A.P.) estimator is given by

$$\hat{x}_{MAP}(y) := \text{Arg max}_z f(z|y)$$

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Unfortunately analytical computations of mean (or mode) are usually not possible.

# Bayesian inference: the Gaussian case

## The Gaussian case

If  $\mathbf{x}$  and  $\mathbf{y}$  are jointly Gaussian described by a density function with mean and variance

$$\mu_z = \begin{bmatrix} \mu_x \\ \mu_y \end{bmatrix}; \quad \Sigma_z = \begin{bmatrix} \Sigma_x & \Sigma_{xy} \\ \Sigma_{yx} & \Sigma_y \end{bmatrix}$$

the conditional density is still Gaussian with mean and variance (if  $\Sigma_y > 0^a$ )

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y}] &= \mu_x + \Sigma_{xy}\Sigma_y^{-1}(\mathbf{y} - \mu_y) \\ \text{Var}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y}] &= \Sigma_x - \Sigma_{xy}\Sigma_y^{-1}\Sigma_{yx} \end{aligned}$$

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- $\text{Var}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y}]$  (cond. var. of  $\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y}$ ) can be understood as  $\Sigma_{\tilde{\mathbf{x}}}$  (uncond. var. of  $\tilde{\mathbf{x}}$ ), does not depend on the data, and is given by the difference between  $\Sigma_x$  and  $\text{Var}\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y}] = \Sigma_{xy}\Sigma_y^{-1}\Sigma_{yx}$  (uncond. vars. of  $\mathbf{x}$ ,  $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y}]$ , resp.)

# The Gaussian case: proof

Consider  $\bar{\mathbf{z}} := \mathbf{z} - \mu_{\mathbf{z}} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \Sigma_{\mathbf{z}})$ . Consider a linear transformation of  $\tilde{\mathbf{x}} = \bar{\mathbf{x}} + A\bar{\mathbf{y}}$ ,  $\tilde{\mathbf{y}} = \bar{\mathbf{y}}$  such that  $\tilde{\mathbf{x}} \perp \tilde{\mathbf{y}}$ . That is

$$\mathbb{E}[\tilde{\mathbf{x}}\tilde{\mathbf{y}}^T] = 0 = \Sigma_{\mathbf{xy}} + A\Sigma_{\mathbf{y}} \implies A = -\Sigma_{\mathbf{xy}}\Sigma_{\mathbf{y}}^{-1}$$

Clearly, since linear transforms maintain Gaussianity,

$$\tilde{\mathbf{z}} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \Sigma_{\tilde{\mathbf{z}}}) = \begin{bmatrix} I & A \\ & I \end{bmatrix} \Sigma_{\mathbf{z}} \begin{bmatrix} I & \\ A^T & I \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \Sigma_{\tilde{\mathbf{x}}} & \\ & \Sigma_{\mathbf{y}} \end{bmatrix}, \quad \Sigma_{\tilde{\mathbf{x}}} = \Sigma_{\mathbf{x}} - \Sigma_{\mathbf{xy}}\Sigma_{\mathbf{y}}^{-1}\Sigma_{\mathbf{yx}}$$

and being Gaussian and uncorrelated,  $\tilde{\mathbf{x}}$  and  $\tilde{\mathbf{y}}$  are also independent

$$\begin{aligned} \implies \bar{\mathbf{x}} = \tilde{\mathbf{x}} - A\bar{\mathbf{y}} &\implies \mathbb{E}[\bar{\mathbf{x}}|\bar{\mathbf{y}}] = -A\bar{\mathbf{y}} = \Sigma_{\mathbf{xy}}\Sigma_{\mathbf{y}}^{-1}\bar{\mathbf{y}} \\ \text{Var}[\bar{\mathbf{x}}|\bar{\mathbf{y}}] &= \Sigma_{\tilde{\mathbf{x}}} = \Sigma_{\mathbf{x}} - \Sigma_{\mathbf{xy}}\Sigma_{\mathbf{y}}^{-1}\Sigma_{\mathbf{yx}} \end{aligned}$$

Introducing the means you get the final result.

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- for  $Q = I$ ,  $\mathbb{E}\|\mathbf{x} - g(\mathbf{y})\|_Q^2$  is the scalar variance of the estimation error defined as  $\tilde{\mathbf{x}} := \mathbf{x} - \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y}] \implies \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y}]$  is the *minimum variance estimator* of  $\mathbf{x}$ ;

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- if  $\mathbf{x}$  and  $\mathbf{y}$  are jointly Gaussian, the computation of  $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y}]$  (and  $\text{Var}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y}]$ ) can be explicitly performed and depends only on first and second moments of the joint density;

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What if the functional family of  $g(\cdot)$  is a-priori restricted? E.g. to be linear

# Linear Minimum Mean Squared Error (MMSE) Estimators

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## Linear MMSE Estimator: the Problem (vector form)

The Linear MMSE Estimator is the linear function of the data

$$g(\mathbf{y}) = A\mathbf{y} + b, \quad A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times m}, \quad b \in \mathbb{R}^n$$

that minimizes the mean of the squared estimation error  $\mathbb{E}\|\mathbf{x} - g(\mathbf{y})\|^2$ , that is

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Before jumping to the solution...

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Examples:

- $\mathbb{R}^n$  endowed with the standard Euclidean inner product;
- $L^2(\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P)$  of second order variables of a random experiment  $\{\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P\}$ : the space of variables  $f$ ,  $\mathbb{E}[|f|^2] < \infty$  (mean squared integrable  $\equiv$  finite variance), with inner product  $\langle \xi, \eta \rangle = \mathbb{E}[\xi \bar{\eta}]$  given by the correlation between variables;

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- $L^2(\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P)$  of second order variables of a random experiment  $\{\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P\}$ : the space of variables  $f$ ,  $\mathbb{E}[|f|^2] < \infty$  (mean squared integrable  $\equiv$  finite variance), with inner product  $\langle \xi, \eta \rangle = \mathbb{E}[\xi \bar{\eta}]$  given by the correlation between variables;
- $\mathbf{H}(\mathbf{y}) := \text{span} \{\mathbf{y}_1, \dots, \mathbf{y}_m\} = \left\{ \sum_{i=1}^m a_i \mathbf{y}_i; a_i \in \mathbb{R} \right\} \subseteq L^2(\Omega, \mathcal{A}, P)$  linearly generated by the second order random process  $\mathbf{y}$  (collection of variables) with  $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{y}_i] = 0$  (zero mean) and  $\|\mathbf{y}_i\|_{\mathbf{H}}^2 = \mathbb{E}[|\mathbf{y}_i|^2] = \text{Var}[\mathbf{y}_i] < \infty$  (finite variance).

# Minimum introduction to Hilbert spaces

A Hilbert space  $\mathbf{H}$  is a vector space (over  $\mathbb{R}$  or  $\mathbb{C}$ ) equipped with an inner product  $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$  which is complete w.r.t. the norm  $\|x\| = \sqrt{\langle x, x \rangle}$  induced by the inner product. That is, every Cauchy sequence converges with respect to  $\|\cdot\|$ .

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$\Rightarrow$  resorting to Hilbert spaces and, in particular,  $\mathbf{H}(\mathbf{y})$  allows to interpret the problem geometrically!

## Theorem: Orthogonal Projections (scalar form)

Let  $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbf{H}$  be a (scalar) random variable. Let  $\mathbf{H}(\mathbf{y}) \subset \mathbf{H}$ . The variable  $\mathbf{z}^* \in \mathbf{H}(\mathbf{y})$  minimizing  $\|\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{z}\|_{\mathbf{H}}^2 = \mathbb{E}[|\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{z}|^2]$  is unique and is the orthogonal projection of  $\mathbf{x}$  onto  $\mathbf{H}(\mathbf{y})$ . Necessary and sufficient condition for  $\mathbf{z}^*$  to be the orthogonal projection is that

$$\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{z}^* \perp \mathbf{H}(\mathbf{y}) \quad \equiv \quad \mathbb{E}[(\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{z}^*)\mathbf{y}_i] = 0 \quad i \in \{1, \dots, m\}$$

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Thanks to this fundamental theorem, the properties inherited from Hilbert spaces and the correspondence between the notion of orthogonality ( $\perp$ ) and uncorrelation (through the inner product/norm) a solution to the *Linear MMSE Estimator* can be drawn (directly in vector form from a element-wise application of the projection theorem).

# Linear Minimum Mean Squared Error (MMSE) Estimators

Restricting  $g(\cdot)$  to the family of linear unbiased functions of  $\mathbf{y}$ , we have

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## Linear MMSE Estimator: the Problem (vector form)

The Linear MMSE Estimator is the linear function of the data

$$g(\mathbf{y}) = A\mathbf{y} + b, \quad A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times m}, \quad b \in \mathbb{R}^n$$

that minimizes the mean of the squared estimation error  $\mathbb{E}\|\mathbf{x} - g(\mathbf{y})\|^2$ , that is

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It can be shown that the solution  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(\mathbf{y}) = g^*(\mathbf{y})$  (also denoted  $\hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y}]$ ) is given by

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}}(\mathbf{y}) = \mu_{\mathbf{x}} + \Sigma_{\mathbf{xy}}\Sigma_{\mathbf{y}}^{-1}(\mathbf{y} - \mu_{\mathbf{y}})$$

that is  $A^* = \Sigma_{\mathbf{xy}}\Sigma_{\mathbf{y}}^{-1}$ ,  $b^* = \mu_{\mathbf{x}} - A^*\mu_{\mathbf{y}}$ . Equivalently to the Gaussian case, it depends only of the first and second moments of the joint density.

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## 2 Linear Theory: Minimum Variance Linear Estimator for Stochastic Processes

# Considerations

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2. Processes  $\implies$  so far we considered  $\mathbf{x}$  and  $\mathbf{y}$  of fixed known dimensions. We now turn to the more interesting (and more useful) setting of “continuous” flow of new measurements  $\{\mathbf{y}(t)\}$  of a (most often) time-varying signal  $\{\mathbf{x}(t)\}$ . In this scenario, the time interval  $I$ , during which data/measurements  $\{\mathbf{y}(t)\}_{t \in I}$  flow, increases. Hence, it appears clearly how a suitable algorithmic structure to process an increasing amount of data becomes indeed fundamentally important.

## Some more notation related to Hilber spaces...

- When dealing with (random) processes  $\mathbf{y}(t)$  (collection of variables) over time, i.e.,  $\{\mathbf{y}_k(t), t \in \mathbb{Z}, k = \{1, \dots, m\}\}$ , the Hilbert space  $\mathbf{H}(\mathbf{y}) \subset \mathbf{H}$  generated by the (second order) process can be defined as

$$\begin{aligned}\tilde{\mathbf{H}}(\mathbf{y}) &= \left\{ \sum a_{ki} \mathbf{y}_k(t_i); a_{ki} \in \mathbb{R}, t_i \in \mathbb{Z}, k = \{1, \dots, m\} \right\} \\ \mathbf{H}(\mathbf{y}) &= \overline{\text{span}} \{ \mathbf{y}(t), t \in \mathbb{Z} \} = \text{cls} \{ \tilde{\mathbf{H}}(\mathbf{y}) \}\end{aligned}$$

with  $\text{cls} \{ \cdot \}$  denoting the formal operation of closure that is completing the corresponding space with the limits of all its Cauchy sequences which, in the case of infinite dimensional space, could not own to the original space.<sup>4</sup>

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$$\mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y}) := \overline{\text{span}} \{ \mathbf{y}(s); s \leq t \}; \quad \mathbf{H}_s^-(\mathbf{y}) \subseteq \mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y}), s \leq t; \quad \lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} \mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y}) = \mathbf{H}(\mathbf{y})$$

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In particular if  $s < t$

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# State Space models

Let  $\{\mathbf{y}(t)\}$  an  $m$ -dimensional stochastic process defined on  $[t_0, \infty)$ .

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Essentially a finite dimensional process can be described as the output of a (time-varying) linear dynamical system driven by white noise.

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# State Space models - the state process

## Markov property

$\{\mathbf{x}(t)\}$  is a weak (sometimes also referred to as second-order) Markov process, i.e.,

$$\hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{x}(t)|\mathbf{H}_s(\mathbf{x})] = \hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{x}(t)|\mathbf{x}(s)] \quad \forall t \geq s$$

being  $\mathbf{H}_s(\mathbf{x}) = \mathbf{H}_s^-(\mathbf{x})$  the Hilbert space generated by  $\{\mathbf{x}(t_0), \dots, \mathbf{x}(s)\}$ . If  $\{\mathbf{n}(t)\}$  and  $\mathbf{x}_0$  are jointly Gaussian,  $\{\mathbf{x}(t)\}$  is strongly Markov (i.e., replace  $\hat{\mathbb{E}}$  by  $\mathbb{E}$ , equivalently the entire distribution).

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### Sketch of proof:

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = A^{t-t_0}\mathbf{x}_0 + \sum_{k=t_0}^{t-1} A^{t-1-k} B \mathbf{n}(k) = A^{t-s}\mathbf{x}(s) + \sum_{k=s}^{t-1} A^{t-1-k} B \mathbf{n}(k), \quad t \geq s$$

$$\Rightarrow \{\mathbf{x}(t)\} \text{ linear in } \mathbf{x}_0, \{\mathbf{n}(t_0), \dots, \mathbf{n}(t-1)\} \Rightarrow \mathbf{x}(t) \perp \mathbf{H}_t^+(\mathbf{n}) \Rightarrow \mathbf{H}_s^-(\mathbf{x}) \perp \mathbf{H}_s^+(\mathbf{n})$$

$$\Rightarrow \hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{x}(t)|\mathbf{H}_s^-(\mathbf{x})] = \hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{x}(t)|\mathbf{x}(s)] = A^{t-s}\mathbf{x}(s)$$

For the Gaussian case,  $\hat{\mathbb{E}} \equiv \mathbb{E}$ . Also the entire conditional probability depends on the past only through the conditional mean hence the property holds “globally”.

# State Space models - the state process

The same “memory” property holds wrt the output process  $\{\mathbf{y}(t)\}$

$$\hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{x}(t)|\mathbf{H}_s^-(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y})] = \hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{x}(t)|\mathbf{x}(s)]$$

$$\hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{y}(t)|\mathbf{H}_s^-(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y})] = \hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{y}(t)|\mathbf{x}(s)], \quad t \geq s$$

being  $\mathbf{H}_s^-(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y}) = \mathbf{H}_s^-(\mathbf{x}) \vee \mathbf{H}_{s-1}^-(\mathbf{y})$  vector sum of  $\mathbf{H}_s^-(\mathbf{x})$  (past and present wrt to  $s$ ) and  $\mathbf{H}_{s-1}^-(\mathbf{y})$  (strict past wrt to  $s$ ).

# State Space models - the state process

The same “memory” property holds wrt the output process  $\{\mathbf{y}(t)\}$

$$\hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{x}(t)|\mathbf{H}_s^-(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y})] = \hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{x}(t)|\mathbf{x}(s)]$$

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## Conditional Incorelation (Orthogonality)

Define  $\mathbf{z}(t) := [\mathbf{x}(t+1)^T, \mathbf{y}(t)^T]^T$ ,

$$\mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{z}) := \mathbf{H}_{t+1}^-(\mathbf{x}) \vee \mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y}), \quad \mathbf{H}_t^+(\mathbf{z}) := \mathbf{H}_{t+1}^+(\mathbf{x}) \vee \mathbf{H}_t^+(\mathbf{y})$$

$$\mathbf{X}_t := \text{span} \{\mathbf{x}_1(t), \dots, \mathbf{x}_n(t)\} \quad \text{state space of } \mathbf{x} \text{ at } t$$

then

$$\mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{z}) \perp \mathbf{H}_t^+(\mathbf{z}) \mid \mathbf{X}_t \implies \hat{\mathbf{z}}(t) = \hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{z}(t)|\mathbf{x}(t)] = \begin{bmatrix} A \\ C \end{bmatrix} \mathbf{x}(t)$$

# State Space models - moments

From  $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{n}] = 0$  and previous (conditional) incorrelation properties, the evolution of mean and covariance of a linear finite dimensional system is described by

$$\mu_{\mathbf{x}}(t+1) = A\mu_{\mathbf{x}}(t), \quad \mu_{\mathbf{x}}(t_0) = \mu_0$$

$$\mu_{\mathbf{y}}(t) = C\mu_{\mathbf{x}}(t)$$

$$\Sigma_{\mathbf{x}}(t, s) = \begin{cases} A^{t-s}\Sigma(s), & t \geq s \\ \Sigma(t)(A^T)^{s-t}, & t \leq s \end{cases}$$

$$\Sigma_{\mathbf{y}}(t, s) = \begin{cases} CA^{t-s-1}G(s), & t > s \\ C\Sigma(t)C^T + DD^T, & t = s \\ G(t)^T(A^T)^{s-t-1}C^T, & t < s \end{cases}$$

$$G(s) = A\Sigma(s)C^T + BD^T$$

and  $\Sigma(t) = \text{Var}[\mathbf{x}(t)]$  is the solution of the discrete Lyapunov equation

$$\Sigma(t+1) = A\Sigma(t)A^T + BB^T, \quad \Sigma(t_0) = \Sigma_0$$

# State Space models - stability and (asymptotic) stationarity

Stability and (asymptotic) stationarity<sup>6</sup> of the underlying processes play an important role in the relation between the Wiener-Kolmogorov and Kalman theories.

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<sup>6</sup>Evolution of covariance depends on  $\tau = t - s$ ,  $\Sigma(s, t) = \Sigma(\tau)$ , for  $t, s \geq t_0$  and  $t - t_0 \rightarrow \infty$ .

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- If  $\mathbf{x}_0 \sim (0, \Sigma_{\infty})$ , then  $\{\mathbf{x}(t)\}, \{\mathbf{y}(t)\}$  are weakly stationary ( $\forall t \geq t_0$ ) with

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Under the above conditions<sup>a</sup> the two approaches (Wiener-Kolmogorov and Kalman) are essentially equivalent.

<sup>a</sup>For finite LTI systems, stationarity translates into rationality of the transfer function and, in turn, ARMA/ARMAX representation. Hence the possibility to practically compute the filter transfer function.

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# State Space models - a common alternative notation

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{x}(t+1) &= A\mathbf{x}(t) + B\mathbf{n}(t), & \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{n}(t)] &= 0, \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{n}(t)\mathbf{n}(s)^T] = I\delta_{ts} \\ \mathbf{y}(t) &= C\mathbf{x}(t) + D\mathbf{n}(t), & t \geq t_0, \mathbf{x}(t_0) &= \mathbf{x}_0\end{aligned}$$

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By defining  $\mathbf{v}(t) := B\mathbf{n}(t)$  (state/process noise) and  $\mathbf{w}(t) := D\mathbf{n}(t)$  (measurement/observation noise) and  $\mathbf{z}(t) = [\mathbf{x}(t)^T \quad \mathbf{y}(t-1)^T]^T$ , we have

$$\mathbf{z}(t+1) = \begin{bmatrix} A \\ C \end{bmatrix} \mathbf{z}(t) + \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{v}(t) \\ \mathbf{w}(t) \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbb{E} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{v}(t) \\ \mathbf{w}(t) \end{bmatrix} = 0, \quad \text{Var} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{v}(t) \\ \mathbf{w}(t) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} Q & S \\ S^T & R \end{bmatrix}$$

Often, in practical scenarios,  $S = 0$  i.e. uncorrelated process and measurement noise.

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## Assumptions (for simplicity):

- Scalar (input and output, SISO) processes. For MIMO processes, generalization using matrix polynomials
- $A(z^{-1})$  and  $C(z^{-1})$  are already monic (highest order coeff. =1)

# Realization: Controllable Canonical Form

The ARMAX description in transfer functions terms can be written:

$$y_k = \frac{B(z^{-1})}{A(z^{-1})} u_k + \frac{C(z^{-1})}{A(z^{-1})} e_k$$

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$$x_{k+1} = A_c x_k + B_c u_k + B_c e_k, \quad y_k = (C_u + C_e) x_k + D_u u_k + D_e e_k.$$

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$$A_c = \begin{bmatrix} -a_1 & -a_2 & \cdots & -a_{n-1} & -a_n \\ 1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & \cdots & 0 & 0 \\ \vdots & & \ddots & & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad B_c = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad D_u = b_0, \quad D_e = 1$$
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**Controllable form:** controllability matrix from  $(A_c, B_c)$  has full rank, i.e., the system is controllable (input drives the state everywhere in finite time).

# Realization: Controllable Form - Example (part 1)

Consider the ARMAX model

$$y_k = \frac{b_0 + b_1 z^{-1}}{1 + a_1 z^{-1} + a_2 z^{-2}} u_k + \frac{1 + c_1 z^{-1}}{1 + a_1 z^{-1} + a_2 z^{-2}} e_k$$

where

$$A(z^{-1}) = 1 + a_1 z^{-1} + a_2 z^{-2},$$

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Using the above formulas, the state space matrix are

$$A_c = \begin{bmatrix} -a_1 & -a_2 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad B_c = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad D_u = b_0, \quad D_e = 1,$$

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$$C_u = [b_1 - a_1 b_0 \quad -a_2 b_0], \quad C_e = [c_1 - a_1 \quad -a_2]$$

corresponding to the transfer function

$$y_k = (C_u(zI - A_c)^{-1} B_c + D_u) u_k + (C_e(zI - A_c)^{-1} B_c + D_e) e_k$$

# Realization: Controllable Form - Example (part 2)

Explicit computation lead (for the first term, the second can be similarly checked)

$$\begin{aligned}C_u(zI - A_c)^{-1}B_c + D_u &= [b_1 - a_1b_0 \quad -a_2b_0] \begin{bmatrix} z + a_1 & a_2 \\ -1 & z \end{bmatrix}^{-1} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} + b_0 \\&= [b_1 - a_1b_0 \quad -a_2b_0] \frac{1}{z^2 + a_1z + a_2} \begin{bmatrix} z & -a_2 \\ 1 & z + a_1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} + b_0 \\&= \frac{(b_1 - a_1b_0)z - a_2b_0 + b_0(z^2 + a_1z + a_2)}{z^2 + a_1z + a_2} \\&= \frac{b_1z + b_0z^2}{z^2 + a_1z + a_2} \\&= \frac{z}{z^2} \frac{b_1 + b_0z}{1 + a_1z^{-1} + a_2z^{-2}} \\&= z^{-1} \frac{b_1 + b_0z}{1 + a_1z^{-1} + a_2z^{-2}} = \frac{b_0 + b_1z^{-1}}{1 + a_1z^{-1} + a_2z^{-2}}\end{aligned}$$

# Realization: Observable Canonical Form (Dual)

A dual (observable) state space form with state  $x_k \in \mathbb{R}^{n_a}$  is

$$x_{k+1} = A_o x_k + B_u u_k + B_e e_k, \quad y_k = C_o x_k + D_u u_k + D_e e_k.$$

where the **observable canonical matrices** are built as the dual of the controllable companion form, i.e.,  $A_o = A_c^\top$  and  $C_o = B_c^\top$ .

$$A_o = A_c^\top = \begin{bmatrix} -a_1 & 1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ -a_2 & 0 & 1 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & & \ddots & \vdots \\ -a_{n-1} & 0 & 0 & \cdots & 1 \\ -a_n & 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad C_o = B_c^\top = [1 \quad 0 \quad \cdots \quad 0]$$
$$B_u := \begin{bmatrix} b_1 - a_1 b_0 \\ b_2 - a_2 b_0 \\ \vdots \\ b_n - a_n b_0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad B_e := \begin{bmatrix} c_1 - a_1 \\ c_2 - a_2 \\ \vdots \\ c_n - a_n \end{bmatrix} \quad D_u = b_0, \quad D_e = 1$$

**Observable form:** observability matrix from  $(A_o, C_o)$  has full rank, i.e., the state can be reconstructed from a finite window of outputs.

# Realization: Innovation (Kalman) Form

An **innovation-form** (a.k.a. **Kalman form**) state-space model is

$$x_{k+1} = A x_k + B u_k + K e_k, \quad y_k = C x_k + D u_k + e_k.$$

defined by interpreting  $e_k = y_k - \hat{y}_{k|k-1}$  as innovation.

For monic ARMAX, a convenient choice, consistent with the controllable realization, is

$$A := A_c, \quad B := B_c, \quad C := (C_u + C_e), \quad D := D_u, \quad K := B_c, \quad D_e := 1,$$

so that

$$\begin{aligned} x_{k+1} &= A_c x_k + B_c u_k + B_c e_k, \\ y_k &= (C_u + C_e) x_k + D_u u_k + e_k. \end{aligned}$$

equivalent to the controllable form.

**Innovation form:** the noise enters as a *one-step-ahead prediction error*.

# Realization: Observer (Predictor) Form

Assuming an innovation-form model

$$x_{k+1} = A x_k + B u_k + K e_k, \quad y_k = C x_k + D u_k + e_k.$$

Eliminate the unmeasured innovation  $e_k$  using  $e_k = y_k - (C x_k + D u_k)$ .

Substitute into the state update to get the **observer / predictor form**:

$$x_{k+1} = (A - KC) x_k + (B - KD) u_k + K y_k, \quad \hat{y}_{k|k-1} = C x_k + D u_k.$$

For consistency with the controllable ARMAX realization:

$$A := A_c, \quad B := B_c, \quad C := (C_u + C_e), \quad D := D_u, \quad K := B_c,$$

**Observer (predictor) form:** state propagated using the measured output  $y_k$ .

**Note:** this form is not really generative. Rather  $y_k$  are assumed to be available.

# Realization: Continuous to Discrete (Exact) (part 1)

Consider a general CT model

$$\begin{aligned}\dot{x}(t) &= A x(t) + B u(t) + G w(t) \\ y(t) &= C x(t) + D u(t) + v(t)\end{aligned}$$

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Assume a sampling period  $T > 0$  and **zero-order hold (ZOH)** input, the equations for  $t \in [kT, (k+1)T]$  leads to

$$x(t) = e^{A(t-kT)} x_k + \int_{kT}^t e^{A(t-\tau)} B u(\tau) d\tau + \int_{kT}^t e^{A(t-\tau)} G w(\tau) d\tau.$$

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and evaluate at  $t = (k+1)T$  to

$$x_{k+1} = e^{AT} x_k + \left( \int_0^T e^{A(T-\tau)} B d\tau \right) u_k + \int_0^T e^{A(T-\tau)} G w(kT + \tau) d\tau.$$

# Realization: Continuous to Discrete (Exact) (part 2)

With the change of variable  $\sigma = T - \tau$  and output sampling, we get:

$$x_{k+1} = A_d x_k + B_d u_k + w_k$$

$$y_k = C x_k + D u_k + v_k.$$

$$A_d := e^{AT}, \quad B_d := \int_0^T e^{A\sigma} B d\sigma, \quad w_k := \int_0^T e^{A\sigma} G w(kT + T - \sigma) d\sigma.$$

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$$A_d := e^{AT}, \quad B_d := \int_0^T e^{A\sigma} B d\sigma, \quad w_k := \int_0^T e^{A\sigma} G w(kT + T - \sigma) d\sigma.$$

If  $w(t)$  is CT white noise with spectral density  $Q_c$ ,  $E[w(t)w(\tau)^\top] = Q_c \delta(t - \tau)$ , then  $w_k$  is discrete-time white with

$$Q_d := E[w_k w_k^\top] = \int_0^T e^{A\sigma} G Q_c G^\top e^{A^\top \sigma} d\sigma.$$

**Note:** there are also other (simpler but inexact) discretization techniques, e.g. Forward/Backward Euler etc.

# Example of non-stationary process

A process is **stationary** when its statistical properties (mean, variance, autocorrelation) do not change over time. Typically arise from **stable systems**.

- thermal noise in an electrical resistor
- vibrations in mechanical systems
- turbulent flow velocity fluctuations
- noise in sensors

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A process is **non-stationary** when its statistical properties change over time. Often caused by: integration, accumulation, system drift.

- particle under Brownian motion (diffusion process)
- position of a vehicle (tracking navigation)
- financial asset prices

# State-Space Derivation of ARIMA( $p, d, q$ ) (part 1)

Let  $\Delta := 1 - z^{-1}$  (difference operator). An ARIMA( $p, d, q$ ) process satisfies

$$A(z^{-1}) \Delta^d y_k = C(z^{-1}) e_k, \quad e_k \sim WN(0, \sigma^2),$$

with monic polynomials

$$A(z^{-1}) = 1 + a_1 z^{-1} + \cdots + a_p z^{-p}, \quad C(z^{-1}) = 1 + c_1 z^{-1} + \cdots + c_q z^{-q}.$$

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For an ARIMA model, define the stationary differenced series

$$z_k := \Delta^d y_k.$$

Then

$$A(q^{-1}) z_k = C(q^{-1}) e_k$$

is an ARMA( $p, q$ ) model for  $z_k$ .

# State-Space Derivation of ARIMA( $p, d, q$ ) (part 2)

Find a  $n$ -dim innovation realization ( $n = \max\{p, q + 1\}$ ) for the ARMA for  $z_k$

$$x_{k+1}^z = A_z x_k^z + K_z e_k, \quad z_k = C_z x_k^z + e_k,$$

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Add  $d$  discrete integrators  $s_k^{(1)}, \dots, s_k^{(d)}$  to recover  $y_k = s_k^{(d)}$  from  $z_k = \Delta^d y_k$

$$s_{k+1}^{(1)} = s_k^{(1)} + z_{k+1}, \quad \dots, \quad s_{k+1}^{(d)} = s_k^{(d)} + s_{k+1}^{(d-1)},$$

Equivalently, with  $s_k := \begin{bmatrix} s_k^{(1)} & \dots & s_k^{(d)} \end{bmatrix}^\top$  and  $T_d$  the “cumulative-sum” matrix:

$$s_{k+1} = T_d s_k + b_d z_{k+1}, \quad y_k = e_d^\top s_k, \quad b_d^\top = e_d^\top = [0, \dots, 0, 1]$$

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Let be  $x_k := \begin{bmatrix} (x_k^z)^\top & s_k^\top \end{bmatrix}^\top$ , using the ARMA equations

$$x_{k+1} = \begin{bmatrix} A_z & 0 \\ b_d C_z A_z & T_d \end{bmatrix} x_k + \begin{bmatrix} K_z \\ b_d C_z K_z \end{bmatrix} e_k + \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ b_d \end{bmatrix} e_{k+1},$$
$$y_k = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & e_d^\top \end{bmatrix} x_k.$$

# Example: tracking in 2D

Assume random acceleration driving the motion. The particle position motion is

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{p}_{k+1} &= \mathbf{p}_k + T\mathbf{v}_k, & \mathbf{p}_k &= \begin{bmatrix} x_k \\ y_k \end{bmatrix} \\ \mathbf{v}_{k+1} &= \mathbf{v}_k + T\mathbf{a}_k, & \mathbf{a}_k &\sim WN(\mathbf{0}, \sigma_a^2 I_2)\end{aligned}$$

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Removing  $\mathbf{v}_k$ , the position satisfies the ARIMA(0, 2, 0) model

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Following the above describe realization procedure, the state space model reads

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{x}_{k+1} &= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & T & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & T \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \mathbf{x}_k + \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \mathbf{a}_k, & \mathbf{a}_k &\sim WN(\mathbf{0}, \sigma_a^2 I_2). \\ \mathbf{y}_k &= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \mathbf{x}_k + \mathbf{w}_k & \mathbf{w}_k &\sim WN(\mathbf{0}, R).\end{aligned}$$

# The Kalman Filter: reference state space model

In the following we consider the general state space model of the process  $\{\mathbf{y}(t)\}$

$$\mathbf{x}(t+1) = A\mathbf{x}(t) + \mathbf{v}(t)$$

$$\mathbf{y}(t) = C\mathbf{x}(t) + \mathbf{w}(t) \quad \mathbb{E} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{v}(t) \\ \mathbf{w}(t) \end{bmatrix} = 0, \quad \text{Var} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{v}(t) \\ \mathbf{w}(t) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} Q & S \\ S^T & R \end{bmatrix}, R \succ 0$$

$$\mathbf{x}(t_0) = \mathbf{x}_0, \quad \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}_0] = \mu_0, \quad \text{Var}[\mathbf{x}_0] = P_0 \succcurlyeq 0, \quad \mathbf{x}_0 \perp \mathbf{v}(t), \mathbf{w}(t) \quad \forall t \geq t_0$$

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**Note:**  $A, C, Q, S, R$  could be time varying.  $R \succ 0$  for simplicity for now because it helps guaranteeing invertibility of the variance of innovation process  $\mathbf{e}(t) = \mathbf{y}(t) - \hat{\mathbf{y}}(t|t-1)$ .

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**1. Prediction** of  $\{\mathbf{y}(t)\}$  from past measurements.

By observing that  $\mathbf{w}(t+1) \perp \{\mathbf{v}(s), \mathbf{w}(s), \mathbf{x}_0, s \leq t\} \supset \mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})$

$$\implies \hat{\mathbf{y}}(t+1|t) = \hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{y}(t+1)|\mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})] = C\hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{x}(t+1)|\mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})] = C\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t)$$

**The prediction can be directly build from the predicted state!!**

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## 2. Filtering of $\{\mathbf{z}(t)\}$ from $\{\mathbf{y}(t)\}$

Say we want to filter  $\mathbf{z}(t)$  from  $\mathbf{y}(t) = \mathbf{z}(t) + \xi(t)$  ( $\xi$  “colored noise”).

$$\mathbf{x}(t+1) = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{x}_1(t+1) \\ \mathbf{x}_2(t+1) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} A_1 & \\ & A_2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{x}_1(t) \\ \mathbf{x}_2(t) \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{v}_1(t) \\ \mathbf{v}_2(t) \end{bmatrix} = A\mathbf{x}(t) + \mathbf{v}(t)$$

$$\mathbf{y}(t) = \mathbf{z}(t) + \xi(t) = \begin{bmatrix} C_1 & C_2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{x}_1(t) \\ \mathbf{x}_2(t) \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} I & I \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{w}_1(t) \\ \mathbf{w}_2(t) \end{bmatrix} = C\mathbf{x}(t) + \mathbf{w}(t)$$

$$\mathbf{z}(t) = \begin{bmatrix} C_1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{x}_1(t) \\ \mathbf{x}_2(t) \end{bmatrix} + \mathbf{w}_1(t) = \bar{C}_1\mathbf{x}(t) + \mathbf{w}_1(t)$$

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**Again, the filtering solution can be directly build for the filtered state!!**

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Note that  $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{v}(t), \mathbf{w}(t)^T] = S$  but  $\mathbf{v}(s) \perp \mathbf{w}(s)$ ,  $s \neq t$ .

$$\begin{aligned} \implies \tilde{\mathbf{v}}(t) &= \mathbf{v}(t) - \hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{v}(t) | \mathbf{H}(\mathbf{w})] = \mathbf{v}(t) - \hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{v}(t) | \mathbf{w}(t)] \quad \perp \mathbf{w}(t) \\ &= \mathbf{v}(t) - SR^{-1}\mathbf{w}(t) \end{aligned}$$

$$\implies \text{Var} \begin{bmatrix} \tilde{\mathbf{v}}(t) \\ \mathbf{w}(t) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \tilde{Q} & \\ & R \end{bmatrix}, \quad \tilde{Q} = Q - SR^{-1}S^T$$

$$\implies \mathbf{x}(t+1) = A\mathbf{x}(t) + \mathbf{v}(t) = F\mathbf{x}(t) + SR^{-1}\mathbf{y}(t) + \tilde{\mathbf{v}}(t), \quad F = A - SR^{-1}C$$

with uncorrelated noise  $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}(t) \perp \mathbf{w}(t)$ .

# The Kalman Filter: equations

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- State:  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t) = F\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t) + SR^{-1}\mathbf{y}(t)$
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where

- $P(t+1|t), P(t|t)$ : the prediction and filtering **errors** variances
- $\Lambda(t) = CP(t|t-1)C^T + R$ : innovation ( $\mathbf{e}(t) = \mathbf{y}(t) - C\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t-1)$ ) variance
- $L(t) = P(t|t-1)C^T\Lambda(t)^{-1}$ : Kalman gain

# The Kalman Filter: equations - proof (part 1)

1. **A-priori (prediction) update.** The one-step ahead estimate is obtained by taking the linear conditional expectation given past measurements  $\mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})$ , recalling that  $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}(t) \perp \mathbf{w}(t) \implies \tilde{\mathbf{v}}(t) \perp \mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})$ :

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t) := \hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{x}(t+1)|\mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})] = F\hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{x}(t)|\mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})] + SR^{-1}\mathbf{y}(t) = F\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t) + SR^{-1}\mathbf{y}(t)$$

The corresponding prediction error  $\tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t) = \mathbf{x}(t+1) - \hat{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t)$  satisfies

$$\tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t) = F\tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t|t) + \tilde{\mathbf{v}}(t)$$

and, since  $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}(t) \perp \tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t|t)$  because

$$\left. \begin{array}{l} \mathbf{x}(t) \in \text{span}\{\mathbf{x}(t_0), \tilde{\mathbf{v}}(s), \mathbf{w}(s); s < t\} \\ \mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y}) \subset \text{span}\{\mathbf{x}(t_0), \tilde{\mathbf{v}}(s-1), \mathbf{w}(s); s \leq t\} \end{array} \right\} \perp \tilde{\mathbf{v}}(t)$$

its covariance evolves as

$$P(t+1|t) = \text{Var}[\tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t)] = FP(t|t)F^T + \tilde{Q}$$

# The Kalman Filter: equations - proof (part 2)

2. **A-posteriori (measurement) update.** At time  $t + 1$  we get  $\mathbf{y}(t + 1) = \mathbf{C}\mathbf{x}(t + 1) + \mathbf{w}(t + 1)$ . Note that

$$\mathbf{H}_{t+1}^-(\mathbf{y}) = \mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y}) \oplus \mathbf{H}(\mathbf{e}(t + 1)) \quad (\text{orthogonal sum})$$

being

$$\mathbf{e}(t + 1) = \mathbf{y}(t + 1) - \mathbf{C}\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t + 1|t) = \mathbf{C}\tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t + 1|t) + \mathbf{w}(t + 1)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \implies \hat{\mathbf{x}}(t + 1|t + 1) &= \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}(t + 1)|\mathbf{H}_{t+1}^-(\mathbf{y})] = \hat{\mathbf{x}}(t + 1|t) + L(t + 1)\mathbf{e}(t + 1) \\ &\quad \hat{\mathbf{x}}(t + 1|t) + L(t + 1)(\mathbf{y}(t + 1) - \mathbf{C}\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t + 1|t)) \end{aligned}$$

where  $L(t + 1) = \text{Cov}[\mathbf{x}(t + 1), \mathbf{e}(t + 1)]\text{Var}[\mathbf{e}(t + 1)]^{-1}$  with

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Cov}[\mathbf{x}(t + 1), \mathbf{e}(t + 1)] &= \text{Cov}[\mathbf{x}(t + 1), \tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t + 1|t)]\mathbf{C}^T + \text{Cov}[\mathbf{x}(t + 1), \mathbf{w}(t + 1)] \\ &= \text{Cov}[\tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t + 1|t), \tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t + 1|t)] = \mathbf{P}(t + 1|t) \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{Var}[\mathbf{e}(t + 1)] = \mathbf{\Lambda}(t + 1) = \mathbf{C}\mathbf{P}(t + 1|t)\mathbf{C}^T + \mathbf{R}, \quad \text{since } \tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t + 1|t) \perp \mathbf{w}(t + 1)$$

# The Kalman Filter: equations - proof (part 3)

The covariance update follows by noting that

$$\mathbf{x}(t+1) - \hat{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t+1) = \mathbf{x}(t+1) - \hat{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t) - L(t+1)\mathbf{e}(t+1)$$

$$\implies \tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t+1) = \tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t) - L(t+1)\mathbf{e}(t+1)$$

$$\implies \tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t+1) + L(t+1)\mathbf{e}(t+1) = \tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t)$$

and being  $\tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t+1) \perp \mathbf{e}(t+1)$

$$P(t+1|t+1) + L(t+1)\Lambda(t+1)L(t+1)^T = P(t+1|t)$$

$$\begin{aligned}\implies P(t+1|t+1) &= P(t+1|t) - L(t+1)\Lambda(t+1)L(t+1)^T \\ &= P(t+1|t) - P(t+1|t)C^T\Lambda(t+1)^{-1}CP(t+1|t)\end{aligned}$$

# Considerations on error covariance update

- 1 To avoid/reduce numerical ill-conditioning it is sometimes preferred to express the covariance update in different forms

$$\begin{aligned} P(t+1|t+1) &= P(t+1|t) - P(t+1|t)C^T\Lambda(t+1)^{-1}CP(t+1|t) \\ &= (I - L(t+1)C)P(t+1|t) \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{symmetrized form} &= [I - L(t+1)C]P(t+1|t)[I - L(t+1)C]^T + \\ &\quad L(t+1)RL(t+1)^T \end{aligned}$$

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- 2 Note that **ALL** the **covariance computations** (error and innovation) as well as the **Kalman Gain** do not explicitly depend on the measurements and can be pre-computed **offline**. This is the major computational burden!
- 3 Conversely, the **state update and prediction** depend on the measurements and must be computed **online**.

# The Kalman Predictor

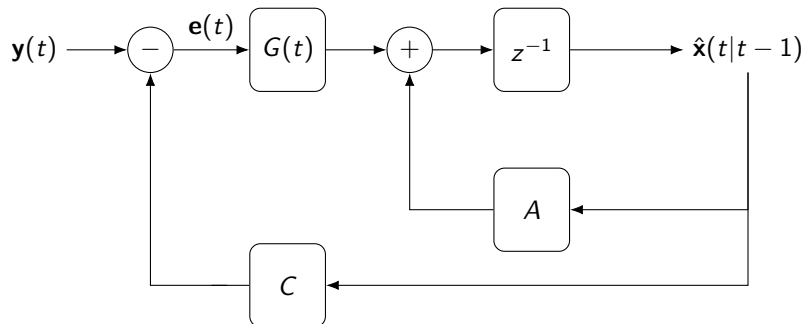
It is often useful to express the dynamics of the predictor which allows to express the next state prediction as function of the previous without computing the filtered value. That is (after some manipulation)

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t) &= F(I - L(t)C)\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t-1) + (FL(t) + SR^{-1})\mathbf{y}(t) \\ &= (F - K(t)C)\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t-1) + (K(t) + SR^{-1})\mathbf{y}(t) \\ &= \Gamma(t)\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t-1) + G(t)\mathbf{y}(t) \\ &= A\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t-1) + G(t)[\mathbf{y}(t) - C\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t-1)] \\ &= A\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t-1) + G(t)\mathbf{e}(t)\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}P(t+1|t) &= F[P(t|t-1) - P(t|t-1)C^T\Lambda(t)^{-1}CP(t|t-1)]F^T + \tilde{Q} \\ &= F[I - L(t)C]P(t|t-1)[I - L(t)C]^T F^T + FL(t)RL^T(t)F^T + \tilde{Q}\end{aligned}$$

where  $K(t) := FL(t)$ ,  $\Gamma(t) := F - K(t)C$ ,  $G(t) := K(t) + SR^{-1}$ .

# Equivalent closed loop interpretation



where the closed-loop dynamics is described by

$$\Gamma(t) = A - G(t)C = F - K(t)C$$

Hence its properties characterize the filter/predictor dynamics.

# Filtered Estimates

Similarly (for  $S = 0$  for simplicity)

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t+1) &= A\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t) + L(t+1)[\mathbf{y}(t+1) - CA\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t)] \\ P(t+1|t+1) &= [I - L(t+1)C]P(t+1|t)\end{aligned}$$

In this case the closed-loop dynamical behavior is described by

$$\Gamma_{\text{flt}}(t) = [I - L(t+1)C]A$$

where before, with  $S = 0$ , was  $\Gamma_{\text{pred}}(t) = A[I - L(t)C]$  which suggest an almost identical asymptotic dynamic behavior.

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*Note that prediction and filtered estimates can directly be computed from the original equations. It is sometimes convenient to get the explicit expressions in order to better understand the role of the measurements in the update.*

# Kalman Filter with Input (part 1)

Reference model (with usual assumptions on noise and initial state):

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{x}(t+1) &= \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}(t) + \mathbf{B}\mathbf{u}(t) + \mathbf{v}(t) = \mathbf{F}\mathbf{x}(t) + \mathbf{S}\mathbf{R}^{-1}\mathbf{y}(t) + \mathbf{B}\mathbf{u}(t) + \tilde{\mathbf{v}}(t) \\ \mathbf{y}(t) &= \mathbf{C}\mathbf{x}(t) + \mathbf{w}(t) + \mathbf{D}\mathbf{u}(t)\end{aligned}$$

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**Easy:** if  $\mathbf{u}(t)$  **known and deterministic**

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t+1|t) &= F\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t) + SR^{-1}\mathbf{y}(t) + B\mathbf{u}(t) \\ P(t+1|t) &= \dots \textit{unchanged} \\ \mathbf{e}(t) &= y(t) - C\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t-1) - D\mathbf{u}(t)\end{aligned}$$

$\Rightarrow$  the deterministic input does not affect the uncertainty, only the trajectory.

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**Harder:** *but what if  $\mathbf{u}(t)$  is a process?* E.g. a (linear) causal function ( $H$ ) of  $\mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})$  plus a process uncorrelated from the entire noise ( $\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{w}$ ) history, say

$$\mathbf{u}(t) = H(\mathbf{y}^t) + \mathbf{r}(t)$$

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In this case, even if  $H \equiv 0$ , it is in general not possible to assume  $\mathbf{u}(t) \perp \mathbf{x}_0$ . Even if  $\mathbf{u}(t)$  is observable,  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}$  based on joint observations  $(\mathbf{y}, \mathbf{u})$  must be obtained by considering the joint state model thus deriving augmented KF equations.

# Kalman Filter with Input (part 2)

Assume the plant and input are described by

$$\begin{cases} \mathbf{x}_1(t+1) &= A\mathbf{x}_1(t) + B\mathbf{u}(t) + \mathbf{v}_1(t) \\ \mathbf{y}(t) &= C\mathbf{x}(t) + \mathbf{w}_1(t) \end{cases}$$
$$\begin{cases} \mathbf{x}_2(t+1) &= F\mathbf{x}_2(t) + G\mathbf{y}(t) + \mathbf{v}_2(t) \\ \mathbf{u}(t) &= H\mathbf{x}_2(t) + J\mathbf{y}(t) + \mathbf{w}_2(t) \end{cases}$$

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This gives rise to the augmented state model to which standard KF can be applied

$$\mathbf{x}(t+1) = \underbrace{\begin{bmatrix} A + BJC & BH \\ GC & F \end{bmatrix}}_A \mathbf{x}(t) + \underbrace{\begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{v}_1(t) \\ \mathbf{v}_2(t) \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} BJ & B \\ G & \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{w}_1(t) \\ \mathbf{w}_2(t) \end{bmatrix}}_{\bar{\mathbf{v}}(t)}$$
$$\begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{y}(t) \\ \mathbf{u}(t) \end{bmatrix} = \underbrace{\begin{bmatrix} C \\ JC & H \end{bmatrix}}_C \mathbf{x}(t) + \underbrace{\begin{bmatrix} I \\ J & I \end{bmatrix}}_D \underbrace{\begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{w}_1(t) \\ \mathbf{w}_2(t) \end{bmatrix}}_{\mathbf{w}(t)}$$

# The Kalman Filter: information form

## 1 Information variables

- Information matrix:  $Y(t|t) \triangleq P(t|t)^{-1}$
- Information state:  $\xi(t|t) \triangleq Y(t|t)\hat{x}(t|t)$

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- $Y(t_0|t_0-1) = P_0^{-1}, \quad \xi(t_0|t_0-1) = P_0^{-1} \mu_0$

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where

- $Y(t|t-1), Y(t|t)$ : the prediction and filtering **information** matrices
- $\xi(t|t-1), \xi(t|t)$ : the corresponding information states
- $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t) = Y(t|t)^{-1} \xi(t|t)$

# Kalman filter vs. Information filter

## Standard Kalman filter

- Propagates

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t), \quad P(t|t)$$

- Measurement update through

$$\Lambda(t) = CP(t|t-1)C^T + R$$

- Gain computation required:

$$L(t) = P(t|t-1)C^T\Lambda(t)^{-1}$$

- Natural for moderate state dimension and direct state reconstruction at each  $t$
- Direct Covariance update

## Key relation

$$Y(t|t) = P(t|t)^{-1}, \quad \xi(t|t) = Y(t|t)\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t)$$

## Information filter

- Propagates

$$Y(t|t), \quad \xi(t|t)$$

- Measurement update is additive:

$$Y^+ = Y^- + C^T R^{-1} C$$

$$\xi^+ = \xi^- + C^T R^{-1} y$$

- No explicit Kalman gain
- Natural for multi-sensor fusion and sparse large-scale problems
- Particularly convenient when measurements are many and independent

# Why information form can be advantageous

## Example: fusion of many independent sensors

Assume  $N$  sensors observe the same state:

$$y_i(t) = C_i x(t) + v_i(t), \quad v_i(t) \sim \mathcal{N}(0, R_i), \quad i = 1, \dots, N$$

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- Sensor contributes an additive information term (computed independently):

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## Main advantage

Updates are simple accumulation of information: more scalable and simpler.

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In the KF context, we deal with estimation of a time-varying random vector based on data and prior information. Hence the relevant bound is what is usually referred to as the **posterior (Bayesian) CRLB**

$$\mathcal{I}(t|t) = -\mathbb{E}[\nabla_{\mathbf{x}}^2 \log p(\mathbf{x}(t) | \mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})) \mid \mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})] \quad \text{Fisher Information Matrix}$$

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- For any unbiased estimator  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}_u(t|t)$  of  $\mathbf{x}(t)$  from  $\mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})$ :

$$\mathbb{E}[\hat{\mathbf{x}}_u(t|t) - \mathbf{x}(t)] = 0, \quad \text{Cov}[\hat{\mathbf{x}}_u(t|t) - \mathbf{x}(t)] \succeq \mathcal{I}(t|t)^{-1}$$

# Cramer-Rao Lower Bound (CRLB) for KF

The CRLB defines the minimum theoretical variance of any unbiased estimator of a deterministic parameter, setting a fundamental limit on estimation precision. It is defined as the inverse of the Fisher information.

In the KF context, we deal with estimation of a time-varying random vector based on data and prior information. Hence the relevant bound is what is usually referred to as the **posterior (Bayesian) CRLB**

$$\mathcal{I}(t|t) = -\mathbb{E}[\nabla_{\mathbf{x}}^2 \log p(\mathbf{x}(t) | \mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})) \mid \mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})] \quad \text{Fisher Information Matrix}$$

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- Under the linear-Gaussian assumptions used for KF:

$$\mathcal{I}(t|t) = \mathbf{Y}(t|t) = \mathbf{P}(t|t)^{-1} \implies \text{Cov}[\hat{\mathbf{x}}_u(t|t) - \mathbf{x}(t)] \succcurlyeq \mathbf{P}(t|t)$$

and the Kalman filter attains the bound:

$$\text{Cov}[\tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t|t)] = \text{Cov}[\mathbf{x}(t) - \hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t)] = \mathbf{P}(t|t).$$

# Cramer-Rao limit (KF): proof of bound attainability

Under the linear-Gaussian assumptions  $\mathbf{x}(t) | \mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y}) \sim \mathcal{N}(\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t), P(t|t))$ , where

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t) = \hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{x}(t) | \mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})] \equiv \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}(t) | \mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})] \quad (\text{the KF})$$

For any estimator  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}_u(t|t)$  based on  $\mathbf{H}_t^-(\mathbf{y})$ , define

$$d(t) := \hat{\mathbf{x}}_u(t|t) - \hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t), \quad \tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t|t) := \mathbf{x}(t) - \hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t).$$

By the orthogonality principle of conditional expectation,  $\mathbb{E}[\tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t|t) d(t)^T] = 0$ .

Hence

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Cov}[\mathbf{x}(t) - \hat{\mathbf{x}}_u(t|t)] &= \text{Cov}[\tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t|t) - d(t)] \\ &= \text{Cov}[\tilde{\mathbf{x}}(t|t)] + \text{Cov}[d(t)] \\ &= P(t|t) + \text{Cov}[d(t)] \succeq P(t|t). \end{aligned}$$

Equality holds iff  $\text{Cov}[d(t)] = 0$  (i.e.,  $d(t) = 0$  a.s.), namely  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}_u(t|t) = \hat{\mathbf{x}}(t|t)$

# Asymptotic Behavior: preliminaries

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*Finally, we assume  $S = 0$ , i.e., uncorrelated noises, to simplify the equations, i.e.  $F = A$ ,  $\tilde{Q} = Q$ ,  $G_t = K_t = AL_t$ ,  $\Gamma_t = A - K_tC$ .*

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We recall the predictor dynamics equal to

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}}_{t+1} = A\hat{\mathbf{x}}_t + K_t [\mathbf{y}_t - C\hat{\mathbf{x}}_t]$$

$$P_{t+1} = A \left[ P_t - P_t C^T (C P_t C^T + R)^{-1} C P_t \right] A^T + Q$$

$$K_t = A P_t C^T [C P_t C^T + R]^{-1}$$

# Asymptotic Behavior: error dynamics

Also, defining the estimation error

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After update we get an error dynamics governed by

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{e}_{t+1} &= (A - K_t C)\mathbf{e}_t + \mathbf{v}_t - K_t \mathbf{w}_t \\ &= \Gamma_t \mathbf{e}_t + \text{noise terms}\end{aligned}$$

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**Essentially, the gain  $\mathbf{K}_t$ , covariance  $\mathbf{P}_t$  and closed-loop error  $\mathbf{\Gamma}_t$  dynamics are governed by the resolution of the discrete-time Riccati Equation (R.E.)**

Therefore:

*asymptotic filter behavior  $\iff$  asymptotic Riccati behavior.*

*Before looking at the behavior for the general case of non-stationary processes, we consider the stationary case*

# Asymptotic Behavior: the stationary case

*In case of stationary processes and, in particular, asymptotically stable systems, i.e., characterized by asymptotically stable state-space matrix  $A$  it is possible to state a strong direct result, connecting KF and Wiener-Kolmogorov theories as well as the asymptotic stability of the filter.*

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If  $A$  is asymptotically stable then

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}}_t = \hat{\mathbb{E}}[\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{y}_0, \dots, \mathbf{y}_t] \xrightarrow[t_0 \rightarrow -\infty]{} \hat{\mathbf{x}}_t^\infty$$

where  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}_t^\infty$  is the Wiener-Kolmogorov predictor of  $\mathbf{x}_t$  based on the infinite past history of  $\mathbf{y}$ . Then, there exists  $\lim_{t_0 \rightarrow -\infty} P_t = P_\infty$  with  $P_\infty$  solution of the Algebraic Riccati Equation (ARE). The prediction satisfies

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{\mathbf{x}}_{t+1}^\infty &= \Gamma_\infty \hat{\mathbf{x}}_t^\infty + K_\infty \mathbf{y}_t \\ K_\infty &= A P_\infty C^T [C P_\infty C^T + R]^{-1} \\ \Gamma_\infty &= A - K_\infty C\end{aligned}$$

And if  $(\Gamma_\infty, K_\infty)$  reachable, then  $\Gamma_\infty$  is asymptotically stable.

# Asymptotic Behavior: structural assumptions

In the more general case of non-stationary processes ( $A$  not asymptotically stable), the behavior is studied through the behavior of  $P_t$  (i.e. of the RE)

Yet, a couple of assumptions are needed. . .

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## Detectability

The pair  $(A, C)$  is *detectable*: i.e., every unstable mode of  $A$  is observable.

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The pair  $(A, Q^{1/2})$  is *stabilizable*: i.e., every unstable mode of  $A$  is reachable through the process noise channel.

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- unreachable unstable modes create pathological Riccati behavior.

$R \succ 0$ , detect. of  $(A, C)$ , stab. of  $(A, Q^{1/2}) \implies \exists!$  stabilizing steady-state  $P_\infty$

# Asymptotic Behavior: fundamental theorem of KF theory

Necessary and sufficient condition for:

- $\exists!$  a symmetric  $P_\infty$  solution of the A.R.E.

$$P = APA^T - APC^T(CPC^T + R)^{-1}CPA^T + Q$$

- the solution  $P_\infty$  is stabilizing
  - $\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} P_t = P_\infty \quad \forall$  initial symmetric positive semidefinite  $P_0$
- is that  $(A, C)$  being detectable and  $(F, Q^{1/2})$  being stabilizable.

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Interpretation:

- after transients, the filter “forgets” the initial covariance,
- the gain becomes constant,
- the estimation error reaches a stationary covariance regime.

# Asymptotic Behavior: steady-state KF

Analogously to the stationary case, once  $P_k$  and  $K_k$  have converged, one can replace the time-varying filter by the constant-gain filter

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{\mathbf{x}}_{t+1|t} &= A\hat{\mathbf{x}}_{t|t}, \\ \hat{\mathbf{x}}_{t+1|t+1} &= \hat{\mathbf{x}}_{t+1|t} + K_{\infty}(\mathbf{y}_{t+1} - C\hat{\mathbf{x}}_{t+1|t}).\end{aligned}$$

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Advantages of the constant-regime filter:

- lower online computational cost,
- simpler implementation in embedded systems,
- explicit LTI error dynamics,
- same asymptotic performance as the full Kalman filter.

Hence, for time-invariant models, the practical end-point is often a *steady-state Kalman filter*.

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$$R \uparrow \Rightarrow K_\infty \downarrow \quad (\text{more trust in the model}).$$

The asymptotic gain is the precise mathematical embodiment of the model/measurement tradeoff.

# Asymptotic Behavior: continuous-time counterpart

For the continuous-time model

$$\dot{x} = Ax + Gw, \quad y = Cx + v,$$

with white noises of intensities  $Q$  and  $R$ , the covariance satisfies the differential Riccati equation

$$\dot{P} = AP + PA^\top + GQG^\top - PC^\top R^{-1}CP.$$

At steady state,  $P_\infty$  solves the continuous algebraic Riccati equation (CARE)

$$AP + PA^\top + GQG^\top - PC^\top R^{-1}CP = 0.$$

Under the analogous detectability/stabilizability assumptions,

$$P_t \rightarrow P_\infty, \quad K_t = P_t C^\top R^{-1} \rightarrow K_\infty = P_\infty C^\top R^{-1}.$$

The constant-regime filter is then the steady-state Kalman–Bucy filter.

# Asymptotic Behavior: take-away results

- 1 The asymptotic behavior of the Kalman filter is governed by a R.E.
- 2 Under

$$(A, C) \text{ detectable,} \quad (A, Q^{1/2}) \text{ stabilizable,} \quad R \succ 0,$$

the Riccati recursion converges to a unique stabilizing solution  $P_\infty$ .

- 3 The filter gain converges:

$$K_k \rightarrow K_\infty.$$

- 4 The estimation error covariance converges:

$$P_k \rightarrow P_\infty.$$

- 5 The asymptotic filter becomes a constant-gain linear filter with the same steady-state performance as the full time-varying Kalman filter.

## 9 Nonlinear Theory

# Linear vs Nonlinear Kalman Filtering

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| Estimator | Model          | Assumed Distribution | Computational Cost                |
|-----------|----------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------|
| KF        | Linear         | Gaussian             | Low                               |
| EKF       | Locally Linear | Gaussian             | Low/Medium (depends on Jacobians) |
| UKF       | Nonlinear      | Gaussian             | Medium                            |
| PFs       | Nonlinear      | Arbitrary            | High                              |

# Extended Kalman Filter (EKF): essentials and notation

- Linearizes nonlinear functions  $f(x, u)$  and  $h(x)$  around current estimate.
- Same equations as linear KF, but with linearized matrices.
- Limitations: Linearization errors, Jacobian computation.

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Consider a discrete-time<sup>7</sup> non-linear state model of the form

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{x}(k+1) &= f(\mathbf{x}(k), \mathbf{u}(k)) + \mathbf{v}(k), \quad \mathbf{v} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, Q) \\ \mathbf{y}(k) &= h(\mathbf{x}(k)) + \mathbf{w}(k), \quad \mathbf{w} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, R)\end{aligned}$$

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under the usual assumptions  $\mathbf{v} \perp \mathbf{w} \perp \mathbf{x}_0$ , and denote the Jacobian matrices

$$F_k = \left. \frac{\partial f}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \right|_{\hat{\mathbf{x}}_k|k} \quad H_k = \left. \frac{\partial h}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \right|_{\hat{\mathbf{x}}_{k+1}|k}$$

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# EKF: discrete-time equations

## 1 Prior estimates

- State:  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k+1|k) = f(\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k|k), \mathbf{u}(k))$
- Variance:  $P(k+1|k) = F_k P(k|k) F_k^T + Q,$

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## 2 Measurement update

- State:  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k+1|k+1) = \hat{\mathbf{x}}(k+1|k) + L(k+1) [\mathbf{y}(k+1) - h(\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k+1|k))]$
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Nonlinearity used to properly propagate the prior estimate and the measurement model to compute the pseudo innovation.

# EKF: generalization - continuous-discrete equations

The EKF is also used in more general setups of continuous-discrete systems.

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<sup>8</sup>Matrix satisfying the Volterra equation which, for constant  $F$ , equals  $\Phi(t,s) = e^{F(t-s)}$ .

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Consider a continuous-time state-model with sampled measurements at discrete instants  $t_k$  (possibly non uniform)

$$\begin{aligned}\dot{\mathbf{x}}(t) &= f(\mathbf{x}(t)) + \xi(t) \\ \mathbf{y}(t_k) &= h(\mathbf{x}(t_k)) + \mathbf{w}(t_k)\end{aligned}$$

being  $\xi$  white noise of intensity  $Q \geq 0$ ;  $\mathbf{w}(t_k)$  white of variance  $R > 0$  and  $\{\xi(t)\} \perp \{\mathbf{w}(t_k)\} \perp \mathbf{x}(t_0)$ .  $f, h \in \mathbb{C}^1$ .

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Let  $\Phi(t, s, \bar{\mathbf{x}})$  be the fundamental matrix<sup>8</sup> associated to the time-varying linear system  $\dot{\mathbf{z}} = F(\bar{\mathbf{x}}(t))\mathbf{z}$  where  $F(\bar{\mathbf{x}}(t)) = \frac{\partial f}{\partial \mathbf{x}}|_{\mathbf{x}=\bar{\mathbf{x}}(t)}$  and define

$$Q(t_k) := \int_{t_k}^{t_{k+1}} \Phi(t_{k+1}, s, \bar{\mathbf{x}}) Q \Phi(t_{k+1}, s, \bar{\mathbf{x}})^T ds$$

Under these conditions, the equations generalize as follows.

---

<sup>8</sup>Matrix satisfying the Volterra equation which, for constant  $F$ , equals  $\Phi(t, s) = e^{F(t-s)}$ .

# EKF: generalization - continuous-discrete equations

## 1 Prior estimates

- State:

- Resolve  $\dot{\bar{\mathbf{x}}}(t) = f(\bar{\mathbf{x}}(t))$ ,  $t \in [t_k, t_{k+1}]$ ,  $\bar{\mathbf{x}}(t_k) = \hat{\mathbf{x}}(k|k)$
- Set  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k+1|k) = \bar{\mathbf{x}}(t_{k+1})$

- Variance:

- $P(k+1|k) = \Phi(k|k)P(k|k)\Phi(k|k)^T + Q(k)$ ,  $\Phi(k|k) := \Phi(k+1, k, \hat{\mathbf{x}}(k|k))$
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## 2 Measurement update

### • State:

- $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k+1|k+1) = \hat{\mathbf{x}}(k+1|k) + L(k+1) [\mathbf{y}(k+1) - h(\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k+1|k))]$
- $L(k+1) = P(k+1|k)H(k+1|k)^T \Lambda(k+1)^{-1}$
- $\Lambda(k+1) = H(k+1|k)P(k+1|k)H(k+1|k)^T + R$
- $H(k+1|k) := H(\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k+1|k)) = \left. \frac{\partial h}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \right|_{\mathbf{x}=\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k+1|k)}$

### • Variance: $P(k+1|k+1) = (I - L(k+1)H(k+1|k))P(k+1|k)$

with initial conditions  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(0, -1) = \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}(t_0)]$ ,  $P(0|-1) = \text{Var}[\mathbf{x}(t_0)]$

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To avoid explicit integration, when the signals are sufficiently slow w.r.t. the sampling time, a full DT scheme is used, by discretizing the CT dynamics, e.g.,

$$\mathbf{x}(k+1) = \hat{f}_k(\mathbf{x}(k)) \stackrel{\text{Euler}}{=} \mathbf{x}(k) + (t_{k+1} - t_k)f(\mathbf{x}(k))$$

also used to propagate the prior estimated state in the filter equations

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k+1|k) = \hat{f}_k(\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k|k))$$

All other equations remain the same assuming now  $\Phi(k|k) = \frac{\partial \hat{f}_k}{\partial \mathbf{x}}|_{\mathbf{x}=\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k|k)}$ .

# Unscented Kalman Filter (UKF)

- Uses sigma points to capture higher-order moments: for any random vector  $\mathbf{x}$ , sigma points are a set of any  $N$  vectors satisfying:
  - first order: weighted average of points corresponds to  $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}]$
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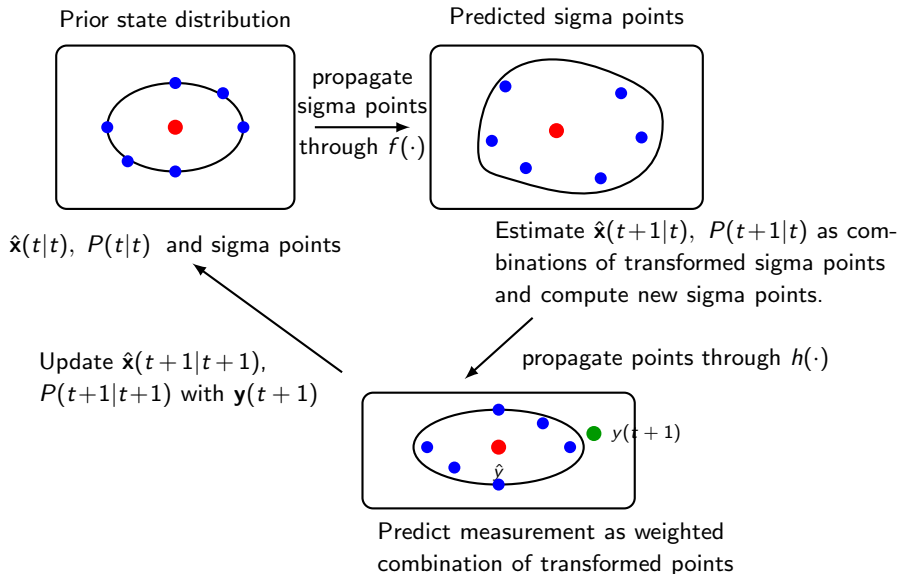
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*UKF equations are not difficult but heavy in notation. We'll see them in code rather than on slides.*

# UKF: graphical representation



# Particle Filters (PFs)

Particle Filters are a family rather than a single estimation algorithm.

General idea:

- use many samples/particle
- use random sampling to approximate any underlying distribution
- often exploit a *genetic* approach consisting of a selection/updating step alternate with a mutation/prediction step

Common implementations are:

- Markov Chain Monte Carlo
- Sequential Importance Sampling (SIS)
- Sequential Importance Resampling (SIR)

## 3 Adds-on

# A Practical Recipe for Tuning a Kalman Filter (part 1)

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- Hold the system still or run in a regime with known truth
- Compute sample covariance of sensor error

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## 3. Check the innovations

$$\nu_k = y_k - H\hat{x}_k^-, \quad S_k = HP_k^- H^\top + R$$

A good filter has innovations that are approximately white, zero-mean, and with the expected size (covariance close to  $S_k$ ).

# A Practical Recipe for Tuning a Kalman Filter (part 2)

## 4. Tune using observed behavior

| Symptom                  | Adjustment                   |
|--------------------------|------------------------------|
| Estimate too noisy       | increase $R$ or decrease $Q$ |
| Estimate too sluggish    | increase $Q$ or decrease $R$ |
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**Best practical rule:** fix  $R$  from measurements, then tune only  $Q$  until the filter is as fast as possible without visibly fitting noise.

### Example sweep

```
for alpha in [1e-3, 1e-2, ..., 1e3]:  
    Q = alpha * Q0  
    run filter  
    inspect innovation variance + tracking lag
```

# Fixed-Interval Rauch-Tung-Striebel Smoother

## Objective of smoothing:

- Fixed-lag: provide an almost real-time (slightly delayed) improved estimate at  $k - N$  using a sliding window of measurements up to  $k$ .
- Fixed-interval: provide the best estimate using all available measurements up to a certain instant  $n$ .

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The RTS smoother<sup>9</sup> consists of:

- forward pass: exactly equal to the standard KF equations to compute  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k|k-1)$ ,  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k|)$ ,  $P(k|k-1)$  and  $P(k|k)$ .

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- backward pass: compute the *smoothed* estimates  $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(k|n)$ ,  $P(k|n)$  via
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Note that, conversely to fixed-lag smoothers, fixed-interval are **offline** algorithms as they require all future measurements up to  $n$ .

---

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# LQG control and its connection to KF

## Problem setup (stochastic optimal control)

$$x_{t+1} = Ax_t + Bu_t + w_t, \quad y_t = Cx_t + v_t, \quad w_t \sim \mathcal{N}(0, Q), \quad v_t \sim \mathcal{N}(0, R)$$

**Objective (LQG cost):**  $J = \mathbb{E} \left[ \sum_{t=0}^T x_t^T Q_x x_t + u_t^T R_u u_t \right]$

**Key result (Separation principle):** Optimal control = LQR + KF

- **State estimation (Kalman filter):**  $\hat{x}(t|t) = \mathbb{E}[x_t | \mathbf{H}_t^-(y)]$
- **Control law (LQR):**  $u_t = -K_t \hat{x}(t|t)$  (Controller uses  $\hat{x}$ , not  $x$ )

## Dual Riccati equations (forward + backward)

- KF covariance:  $P_{t+1} = AP_t A^T + Q - AP_t C^T (CP_t C^T + R)^{-1} CP_t A^T$
- LQR cost2go:  $S_t = A^T S_{t+1} A + Q_x - A^T S_{t+1} B (B^T S_{t+1} B + R_u)^{-1} B^T S_{t+1} A$

| KF (estimation)   | LQR (control)      |
|-------------------|--------------------|
| $A, C$            | $A^T, B^T$         |
| $Q, R$            | $Q_x, R_u$         |
| $P_t$             | $S_t$              |
| $K_t^{\text{KF}}$ | $K_t^{\text{LQR}}$ |

## Interpretation

- KF: optimal *information extraction*
- LQR: optimal *control action*
- LQG: optimal closed-loop system

# Additional resources

- <https://github.com/mintisan/awesome-kalman-filter?tab=readme-ov-file>
- <https://github.com/rlabbe/Kalman-and-Bayesian-Filters-in-Python>
- <https://kalmanfilter.net/>

End! Thank you!